

STAGE EIGHT • SOFT SKILLS

FIRSTS

FAQ

Anticipated participant questions and suggested facilitator responses

A Citrus Edition Facilitator Resource • Companion to the FIRSTS Manual

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FIRSTS • FAQ

Stage Eight • Soft Skills

PURPOSE

These are the questions that come up most often across cohorts of Stage Eight, with a suggested facilitator response for each. Use these as a starting point, not a rigid script.

Frequently Asked Questions

Q1. What if I'm genuinely not comfortable sharing something personal during an exercise?

A: You're never required to share more than you're comfortable with. Several exercises are explicitly opt-in for group sharing, and even the ones that ask for real participation don't require disclosing details you'd rather keep private — you can often share the outcome or the action without the specific personal content behind it.

Q2. What if giving honest feedback to a peer feels genuinely awkward?

A: That discomfort is completely normal and actually the whole point of practicing here, in a lower-stakes setting, rather than for the first time in a real workplace situation where the stakes are higher.

Q3. What if the conflict role-play (FIRST L35) starts to feel like a real disagreement, not a practiced one?

A: Tell your facilitator immediately — this does happen occasionally. The facilitator will pause the exercise and either reset the scenario or offer a private follow-up conversation rather than continuing to role-play through real unresolved feelings.

Q4. I don't consider myself a 'people person' — does this stage still apply to me?

A: Yes, arguably more directly. Soft skills are trainable, not fixed personality traits, and this stage is built specifically around deliberate practice, not natural charisma. Many participants who don't see themselves as naturally social get real, measurable value from this stage.

Q5. What if I disagree with feedback a peer gives me?

A: You're allowed to disagree — their perspective is one data point, not a verdict. Note it, sit with it, and decide for yourself whether it rings true, rather than either dismissing it immediately or accepting it uncritically.

Q6. What if a group exercise surfaces a real tension I have with someone in the room?

A: Speak to your facilitator privately, either during a break or after the session. Real relational tension is worth addressing thoughtfully outside the structured exercise, not worked through live in front of the group.